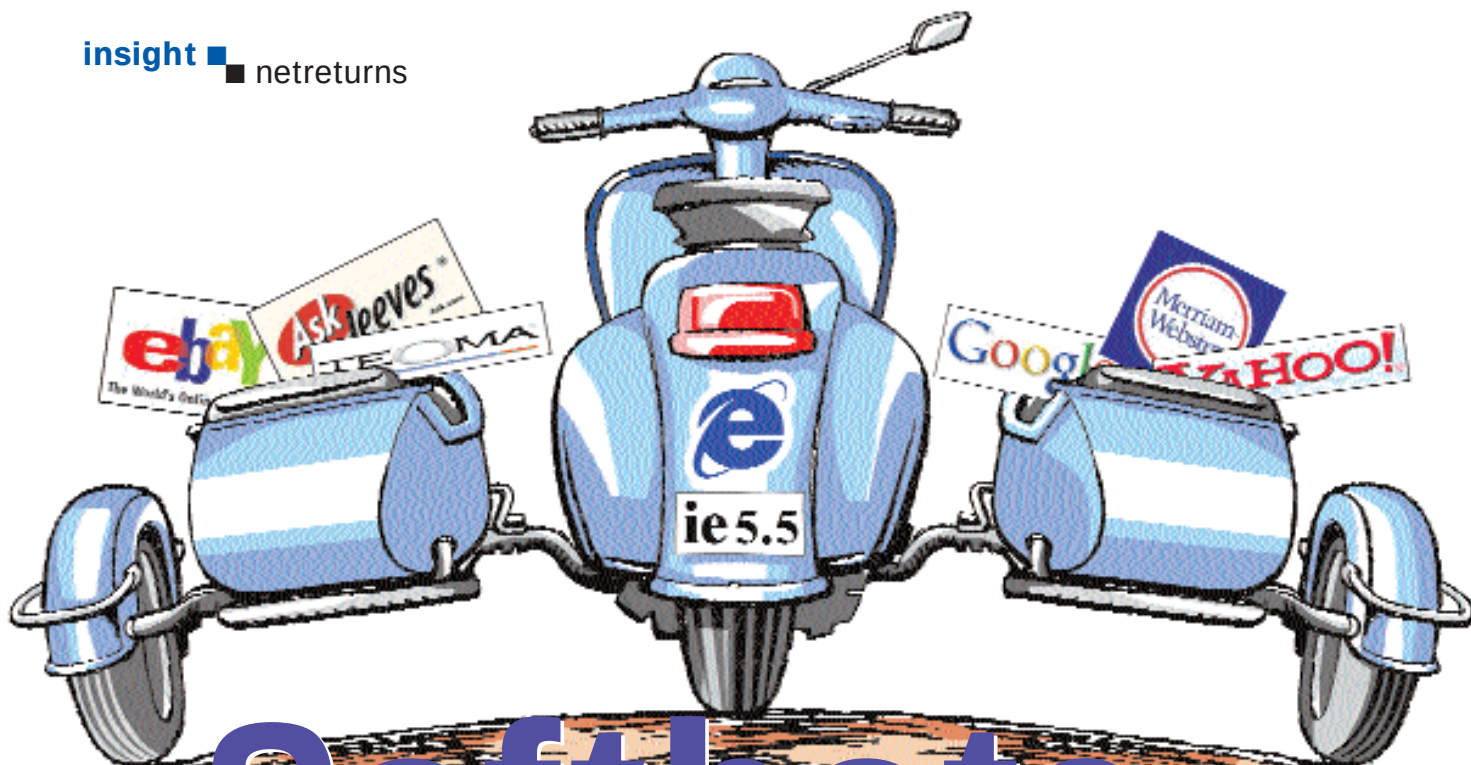




ILLUSTRATIONS: Mahesh Benkar

Softbots at your service

Fast, accurate and straight from within your browser—addons that will speed up your journey as you navigate through the vast and chaotic Net

In this age of technology, information is the key and time is always a constraint. Searching smart on the Internet isn't just a concept—it's an absolute necessity. The World Wide Web is a vast ocean of knowledge and a Net search is much like looking for the proverbial needle in a haystack. While most of us manage to just scratch the surface of the Internet, others maximise their precious online time with the help of power tools. These tools are freely available on the Net and operate from within the browser. They scrounge the Net using intelligent searches for what is relevant to your search and discard what is not, helping you work smarter and more efficiently. The tools listed here are must-haves, especially if you begin your online voyage by jumping into a search engine. Most of them are little browser add-ons that exist as toolbars within the browser. Some others are site-based tools that help you look for more specialised information. The browser add-

ons have been categorised into three types—those used for searching, those used for knowledge and reference searches, and those used for shopping. Of course, quite a few of these toolbars come close to doing all three, thereby saving you desktop real estate.

Seek and ye shall find

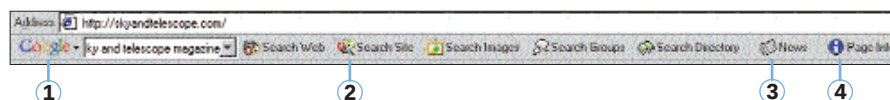
Fast and accurate—that's how we like our online searches. While you can log on to a search engine and have it locate what you want, few know that most of the popular search engines can be directly started from your browser. Seamlessly integrating into your existing browser, the search engines sit as tiny toolbars within your browser. They offer you the convenience of searching straight from your browser without first

having to locate the search engine on the Web—just enter the search criteria within the toolbar search box and start the search. There are several such tools available, with each famous search engine coming out with its own version.

The Google Toolbar

Web site: <http://toolbar.google.com>

Utter 'search' and most people will associate it with Google. The Google toolbar is free, accurate and has some slick features. Type in a query and access the results from Google's Web search or Image search, check out news groups from Google's Groups button or access the Directory search. This toolbar lets you open results in a separate page, so you can start searching, no matter what you are viewing cur-



Google the world: ① Configure the toolbar by clicking on Google. ② Use Search Site to search within the current Web page. ③ Access news from the News button. Page Rank (if enabled) shows you the popularity of the page. ④ The Page Info drop down list gives you a number of options such as to view cached snapshot of the page, view other similar pages, check out the backward links, and even have the page translated into English

AI RoboForm v5.0.2
Find it on the Mindware CD

